



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Reign Christian Academy
School Website: <https://www.reignchristian.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Reign Christian Academy (Denver, CO 80223 area) presents a clearly Christian, classical-leaning program. The school foregrounds a biblical worldview, virtue formation, and a mission to cultivate truth, goodness, and beauty through a classical framework. Public materials emphasize a Christ-centered curriculum, character development, and parental partnership, with explicit statements about integration of faith across subjects and about forming hearts and minds rather than mere information transfer. However, while the school exhibits several hallmark elements of classical education (e.g., classical foundations, Latin/classical language study, logic and critical thinking components, and a governance/leadership structure reflective of a school with a formal mission), some core features typically associated with a fully classical program (notably explicit Socratic pedagogy, detailed Great Books/Great Conversation sequencing, and the full Seven Liberal Arts emphasis) are not consistently named in publicly accessible materials. The aggregate assessment places Reign Christian Academy in the SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL category.

Key drivers of this assessment:

- Strong Religious and Metaphysical Foundations evidenced by explicit statements of Christ-centric, biblical worldview integration, and theological grounding (evidence includes "rooted in Christ," biblical worldview, and a Statement of Faith).
- Clear School Purpose aligned with formation, virtue, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, with articulation of character development and love of learning as aims beyond job-preparation.
- Curriculum features consistent with classical education (classical foundations, Latin/classical languages, logic, critical thinking; reference to great minds of the past and integration of faith). Some elements (explicit Great Books/Great Conversation and Seven Liberal Arts by name) are present in spirit but not always explicit in public copy.
- Pedagogy shows elements of classical approach (focus on logic and critical thinking; emphasis on formation and wonder) but lacks explicit, universal evidence of Socratic seminars, large-scale Classical/traditions-driven pedagogy across grades in the public materials. This yields a partial alignment.
- Faculty structure and leadership are visible (Head of School, board, named teachers), with emphasis on character and formation in teaching roles as part of the school's public narrative. Some classical signals are present, but lack of explicit "living curriculum" language from public copy tempers the strength of the classification.
- Strong Parent & Community partnership signals (parents as co-teachers, tours, admissions processes designed to engage families, and emphasis on family involvement). This aligns with the classical framework's emphasis on partnership with families and formation beyond the classroom.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials repeatedly tie education to Christian faith and biblical truth. Articles and pages describe being “rooted in Christ” with a biblical worldview permeating the curriculum, and a Statement of Faith lays out specific theological commitments.
- The curriculum explicitly mentions integration of faith across subjects.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: truth, wisdom, beauty, virtue, character, moral formation, sacred/Divine order, theology, biblical worldview, Christ-centered education, integration of faith. These map directly to Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements framework (Transcendental Moral Realism; Grounded in Theology; Integration of Faith).
- Negative keywords: None apparent in public materials (no strong signals of secularism or relativism in the publicly accessible copy).

Why this rating

- The school foregrounds transcendental aims (truth, goodness, beauty) anchored in a theistic framework, with explicit theology integration and Christ-centered formation. This strongly aligns with Classical/Transcendental Realism and Theology grounding. The absence of explicit secular/neutral signals in public text supports CLASSICAL here.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school emphasizes formation of hearts and minds and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom (formation over mere information). Public materials talk about pursuing a future filled with joy and opportunity and about character development.
- The public messaging anchors education in truth, goodness, and beauty and presents education as a humane, liberal-arts-oriented formation rather than solely job-prep.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, truth, goodness, beauty, human flourishing, moral imagination, love of learning.
- Negative keywords: Job-prep, workforce-readiness signals are not present in the public copy.

Why this rating

- The language centers on formation, virtue, and the classical telos of education (the truly human, flourishing person) rather than narrowly preparing students for a career. These signals map well to CLASSICAL in the Six Elements framework.

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum presents Classical Foundations and Latin/Classical Languages, plus emphasis on literature, history, mathematics, science; it emphasizes reading great minds (e.g., “great minds of the past”) and integration with faith. There is strong evidence of liberal-arts orientation and logic/critical thinking in the curriculum emphasis.
- The materials show a commitment to history, literature, and the liberal-arts structure (grammar, logic, rhetoric are implied through the emphasis on language arts, critical thinking, and Latin). The explicit naming of the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Quadrivium) is not consistently present in public copy, though the spirit is clear.

- The “Great Books”/Great Conversation framing is alluded to via “great minds of the past” and the classical approach, though explicit Great Books reading lists are not always spelled out in public content.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric) in spirit; Great Books/Great Conversation (great minds of the past); interdisciplinarity and integration with faith; wonder.
- Negative keywords: None observed in public copy (no explicit “social studies” rebranding, no over-emphasis on purely modern, non-liberal-arts approaches).

Why this rating

- The curriculum aligns with core classical aims (liberal arts scaffolds, language arts, logic, integration with faith, and an emphasis on wonder). However, explicit, named Great Books lists and a formal Seven Liberal Arts naming are not consistently visible in accessible public materials, which places it in SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL across the board.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials emphasize a traditional/classical tone (grammar, logic, rhetoric elements appear in curriculum emphasis; critical thinking and logic are named as part of the core subjects). The text stresses a combination of instruction types (teacher-led, tutoring, independent/group study) and formation of character.
- There is no explicit, consistent public mention of Socratic seminars, formal great-books seminars, or chanting/memorization recitation in the public content (these are core signals in the classical pedagogy rubric). The evidence of a fully “Socratic” or “Scholé” approach is not explicit in the accessible site copy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: critical thinking, logic, rhetoric, integration of faith, formation of character, wonder, classical foundation.
- Negative keywords present: lack of explicit Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy; absence of explicit chanting/recitation/memorization signals.

Why this rating

- The program demonstrates classical curricular content (logic, Latin, etc.), but lacks explicit, universally advertised Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy and “Scholé” components in public copy. This yields SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL for Pedagogy.

Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials list named faculty and leadership (Head of School; board; founders; individual teachers such as a 1st-grade teacher). There is explicit emphasis on character formation and on teachers as role models, consistent with the “living curriculum” approach, though the language is not fully explicit in public copy.
- The presence of a founder-led narrative and a board suggests a governance culture that supports virtue, skill, and virtue-based leadership. The publicly visible staff (e.g., Mary Hoesley, 1st-grade teacher) demonstrates teacher presence and relationship-building with families.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: teacher as mentor; living curriculum (conceptually present in classical pedagogy; actual public copy uses teacher roles, character formation, and named teachers). Virtue and character emphasis appear in the curriculum materials.

- Negative keywords present: None explicit in public copy (no signaling language that would clearly undermine classical teacher-mentors or portray teachers as mere technicians).

Why this rating

- While there is clear evidence of dedicated teachers and leadership, the public copy does not consistently employ explicit “model teachers and mentors” or “living curriculum” language. The presence of named faculty and a visible leadership structure supports SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school emphasizes a strong parent partnership, with statements like “We partner with parents to develop the hearts and minds of each child,” and “family involvement is essential,” plus admissions/tour processes designed to engage families (and financial aid discussions). This aligns with the classical emphasis on families as co-educators and a strong community milieu.
- There is explicit language about parent involvement and a belief that family life and parental engagement are essential to student formation. The site also advertises tours, enrollment processes, and open campus-style engagement.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Partnership with Families; formation of affections; cultural transmission; parental involvement; living tradition in the family. The presence of “Parent partnership” and “family involvement” keywords aligns directly with the Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements’ Parents & Community section.
- Negative keywords: None observed in public copy.

Why this rating

- The school shows strong evidence of parent involvement and community partnership, which is central to classical education’s community and family formation. The public materials emphasize parent-teacher collaboration and family engagement, placing this category squarely in CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Assessment

- CLASSICAL: 1, 2, 6
- SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL: 3, 4, 5

Overall ranking: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Rationale: The school demonstrates substantial classical orientation in religious foundations, purpose/goal, and parent/community engagement, and it exhibits many classical curriculum signals and a clear commitment to virtue and formation. However, the Pedagogy category lacks explicit, universally identifiable Socratic/seminar-based methods and explicit Great Books/Seven Liberal Arts labeling in public copy; the Faculty category, while evidenced by named staff, does not consistently use classical terminology in public copy. This mix yields an overall SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating rather than CLASSICAL.

What Would Move the Needle

- Pedagogy: Add explicit, public-facing statements of Socratic seminars or dialectic-based pedagogy for upper grades, and public-facing Great Books/primary-text requirements (or a clearly defined reading list) to demonstrate direct engagement with the Great Conversation. Include terms such as “Scholé” in schedule and daily practices to reflect contemplative, restful learning.
- Curriculum: Publish a clearly named Great Books/Great Conversation list and make explicit reference to the Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) in public materials. Highlight the integration of the Trivium/Quadrivium as the scaffolding of the curriculum.

- Faculty: Use explicit language about the living-curriculum model and teacher-mentorship roles in public content; highlight ongoing teacher development in classical pedagogy with a “portrait of the teacher” and “teacher as exemplar” language in marketing materials.
- Public Communications: Expand Great Books/Philosophical/theological articulation in admissions, tours, and curriculum pages to make classical aims more transparent to prospective families.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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